Efficacy of the Aghora mantra

Kashmir Shaivism – The Secret Supreme
The Birth of the Tantras

In the beginning of *satyuga* Lord Śiva appeared in the form of Svacchandanātha. As Svacchandanātha, He appeared with five heads and eighteen arms. His five heads came into manifestation through his five great energies:

Cit śakti – all consciousness;
Ānanda śakti – all bliss;
Icchā śakti – all will;
Jñāna śakti – all knowledge; and
Kriyā śakti – all action.

These five energies appeared in His five mouths which are known as: Īśāna, Tatpuruṣa, Sadyojāta, Vāmadeva and, Aghora and these five energies got the sensation of illuminating the universe (anugraha). And this grace came out through Lord Śiva's five acts of: creation, protection, destruction, concealing and revealing, for the purpose of illuminating the whole universe.



Svacchanda Bhairava

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अघोरेभ्योऽथ घोरेभ्यो घोरघोरतरीभ्यश्च ।
सर्वतः शर्व सर्वेभ्यो नमस्ते रुद्ररूपेभ्यः ॥

aghorebhyo tha ghorebhyo ghoraghoratarībhyaśca /
sarvataḥ śarva sarvebhyo namaste rudrarūpebhyaḥ //

The following extract on the nature of Svacchandanātha, also known as Aghoranātha (the lord of the three Aghora energies), is taken from: "*Self Realization in Kashmir Shaivism, the Oral Teachings of Swami Lakshmanjoo*," chapter 4, Talks on Discipline.

When we study the Śaiva Scriptures we must always remember that these scriptures were narrated by Lord Śiva Himself in the form of Svacchandanātha (Aghoranātha).

Svacchandanātha, while creating these Tantras through His five mouths, possessed eighteen arms. These eighteen arms are symbols of the eighteen elements or *tattva*s. These *tattva*s are offshoots of His five great *śakti*s:

> ***Cit-śakti*** gives rise to one element, *manas-tattva*, the element of mind.
> ***Ānanda-śakti*** gives rise to two elements, *buddhi* and *ahaṁkāra,* the elements of intellect and ego.
> ***Icchā-śakti*** gives rise to five elements, which are the five vital airs (*vāyu*) of the body. These are *prāṇa, apāna, samāna, udāna,* and *vyāna.*
> ***Jñāna-śakti*** also gives rise to five elements, known as the *jñānendriya*s; these are the five elements of knowledge, which are the nose (*ghrāṇa*)*,* tongue (*jihvā*), eyes (*cakṣuḥ*), skin (*tvak*), , and ears (*śrotra*).
> ***Kriyā-śakti*** gives rise to the five elements of action, the five *karmendriya*s, which are the organ of generation (*upastha*), the organ of excretion (*pāyu*), the organ of mobility (*pāda*), the organ of holding (*pāṇi*)*,* and the organ of speech (*vāk*).

These eighteen arms of Lord Śiva, in the form of Svacchandanātha, are created by Lord Śiva for the protection of the individual, but in order to receive this protection the individual must adhere to divine discipline (*yama*s and *niyama*s). If you carefully follow what I have said, there is no question that Lord Śiva in the form of Svacchandanātha will protect you with His wonderful eighteen arms and, through His shining Grace, reveal Himself to you.

Īśvara-praṇidhāna is the final and supreme *niyama*. It means love and devotion to God. The love of Lord Śiva creates devotion. If you love Lord Śiva and are devoted to Him, it is not possible for Him to neglect you. He will reveal Himself to you and purify you with his glorious eighteen arms. He will help you enter into the realm of God Consciousness.

Efficacy of the Aghora mantra

Tantrāloka 3

tā eva nirmalāḥ śuddhā aghorāḥ parikīrtitāḥ ||257
ghoraghorātarāṇām tu sotṛitvācca tadātmikāḥ |
sṛiṣtau sthitau ca saṁhāre tadupādhitrayātyaye ||258
tāsāmeva sthitam rūpaṁ bahudhā pravibhajyate |

Those very energies when they get functioned in such a way and they become absolutely pure, *aghorāḥ parikīrtitāḥ*, they are nominated as *aghorāḥ* energies of Lord Śiva. Because they are themselves purified and they purify others also. Those who meditate on them . . .

Meditate on which energies?

Aghorā energies.

. . . they purify those also, they carry them to the nature of God consciousness. So they are *aghorā* when they are perfectly supreme and pure.

And there also you find three, triple, energies. One is nominated as *aghorā*, the second is nominated as *ghorā* and the third is nominated as *ghoratarī*.

Aghorā functions in such a way that they carry you to God consciousness at once, without your wish. If you don't desire to get entry in God consciousness you have to, they create desire in you, by *śāmhava* grace.

This is the function of *aghorā* energies.

And *ghorā* energies; if you have desire to get entry in God consciousness, they make you wait. "Don't hurry, just wait, just we will see the time; when the time comes you will get it." . . . (laughs) This happens. This is the function of *ghorā* energies.

And the function of *ghoratarī* energies is this that, when you desire to get entry in the blissful state of God consciousness, you get entry in absolutely degraded state. You are carried down in all actions. In spiritual actions or in not spiritual actions you are carried downwards always. This is the function of *ghoratarī*s.

And this triple way of action comes from those three energies which were situated in God consciousness. *Cit śakti* will produce the energies of *aghorā*s, *icchā śakti* will produce the energies of *ghorā* and *jñāna śakti* will produce the energies of *ghoratarī* there.

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